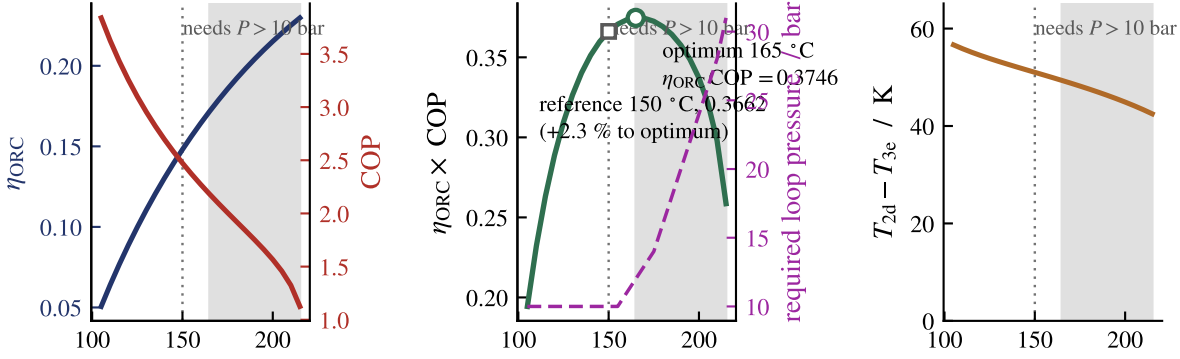
(a) the two machines pull opposite ways

(b) a shallow optimum, bought with pressure

(c) the pinch shortfall is not a quirk of the reference case